

Q8. What is local government? Discuss its importance in a democratic system. Explain the structure and functions of the local government system in Pakistan.

Answer:

Definition of Local Government

Local government is the lowest level of government that manages local affairs and public services at the grassroots level. It deals directly with the daily needs of the people.

Local government manages affairs at the grassroots level.

Importance

The **importance of local government** lies in encouraging public participation, providing quick solutions to local problems, and strengthening democracy. It also reduces the burden on provincial and federal governments.

- Encourages public participation
 - Solves local problems
 - Strengthens democracy
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Structure in Pakistan

In Pakistan, the local government system consists of **Union Councils, Tehsil Councils, and District Councils**. These bodies manage services such as sanitation, water supply, local roads, street lighting, and basic healthcare.

- Union Council
- Tehsil Council
- District Council

Functions

- Water supply
- Sanitation
- Local roads
- Health and education services

Conclusion

Local government plays a key role in democratic development.

What is a Constitution?

A constitution is the supreme law of a country. It is a set of rules and principles that explains how a state is governed.

It defines the structure of government, the powers of different institutions, and the rights and duties of citizens.

All laws of the country must follow the constitution.

Importance of Constitution in a State

- 1. Supreme Law of the Country: The constitution is the highest law and no law can go against it.**
 - 2. Structure of Government: It explains the organization and powers of the executive, legislature, and judiciary.**
 - 3. Protection of Fundamental Rights: It protects the basic rights and freedoms of citizens.**
 - 4. Limits Government Power: It prevents misuse of power by setting legal limits.**
 - 5. Ensures Rule of Law: It ensures that everyone is equal before the law.**
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Types of Constitutions

- 1. Written Constitution: A constitution written in a single document.**
Example: Pakistan and the United States.
- 2. Unwritten Constitution: Not found in one document and based on traditions and customs.**
Example: United Kingdom.
- 3. Rigid Constitution: Difficult to amend and requires special procedures.**
- 4. Flexible Constitution: Can be amended easily through normal law-making procedures.**

Judiciary of Pakistan

The judiciary of Pakistan is the system of courts that interprets and applies the law. It ensures justice according to the Constitution and laws of the country and works independently from the executive and legislature.

The main courts are:

- **Supreme Court:** The highest court and final authority on legal and constitutional matters.
 - **High Courts:** Present in each province and hear major civil and criminal cases and appeals.
 - **District and Session Courts:** Handle most civil and criminal cases at the district level.
 - **Civil and Magistrate Courts:** Deal with minor civil disputes and small criminal cases.
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Importance of Independence of Judiciary

- **Protection of Rights:** Safeguards the fundamental rights of citizens.
- **Fair Justice:** Judges can make decisions without pressure or influence.
- **Check on Government:** Prevents misuse of power by the executive and legislature.
- **Rule of Law:** Ensures everyone is equal before the law.
- **Public Trust:** Increases people's confidence in the justice system.

What is Democracy?

Democracy is a system of government in which the people choose their leaders through elections. It is based on the principle of government of the people, by the people, and for the people. In a democracy, citizens have the right to vote, express their opinions, and participate in political activities.

Pakistan is a democratic country where the system of government works according to the Constitution of Pakistan.

Election Process in Pakistan

The election process allows citizens to elect representatives for the National and Provincial Assemblies.

- 1. Announcement of Elections – Elections are announced by the Election Commission of Pakistan.**
 - 2. Voter Registration – Citizens aged 18 or above are registered as voters.**
 - 3. Nomination of Candidates – Candidates submit nomination papers to contest elections.**
 - 4. Election Campaign – Political parties promote their policies and ask people for votes.**
 - 5. Polling and Voting – Voters cast their votes at polling stations.**
 - 6. Counting and Results – Votes are counted and the candidate with the most votes wins.**
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Role of the Election Commission

The Election Commission of Pakistan (ECP) ensures free and fair elections. Its main duties are:

- Organizing and conducting elections**
 - Preparing voter lists**
 - Monitoring election campaigns**
- Counting votes and announcing results**

Society and Civic Responsibility

Society is a group of people living together who share common values, culture, and laws. Civic responsibility means the duties and responsibilities of citizens to help improve society and contribute to the development of their country.

Major Social Problem Faced by Society Today

One of the major social problems faced by society today in Pakistan is poverty and unemployment. Many people do not have enough job opportunities, which makes it difficult for them to meet their basic needs such as food, education, and healthcare. Poverty can also lead to other issues like crime, illiteracy, and poor living conditions. These problems affect the overall progress and stability of society.

Role of Citizens in Solving the Problem

Citizens can play an important role in solving social problems. They should promote education and skill development so that people can find better job opportunities.

Citizens should also follow laws, pay taxes honestly, and avoid corruption. Helping poor people through charity and community services can also reduce poverty and improve social conditions.

Promoting National Unity

Citizens can promote national unity by respecting different cultures, religions, and languages. They should avoid discrimination and work together for the development of the country. Cooperation, tolerance, and respect among people help strengthen unity and peace in society.